DAILY AI BRIEFING · LEARN ONE THING + WHAT MOVED

Keeping up with the AIs

Meta joins the frontier, and Torvalds puts Claude Code to work

Issue #14 | Tue, 13 Oct 2026 | ☕ ~8 min read

⚡ If you only have one minute

1. **Meta released Muse Wonder**, its first model it calls frontier-class. Meta's own tests put it close to Claude Opus 5.5 and ahead of GPT-6 Astra on some tasks. API price: **$4 / $20 per million tokens**.
2. **Linus Torvalds published Linux kernel patches written with Claude Code** "under my direction". On his laptop, small file reads ran **about 3x faster**.
3. **Part 1 is reviewing AI-written code safely:** what to check before you merge code you didn't type.

Today in three numbers

~3x
more small reads per second in **Torvalds'** Claude-assisted kernel patch

$825
of cheap TV boxes ran a 26B model in **Anthropic's** replication test

$2B+
a year **Microsoft** is on track to pay Anthropic, per The Information

PART 1 Learn one thing

🔍 Reviewing AI-written code safely

4 MIN READ | MODULE 2 · GETTING GREAT RESULTS

AI can write code faster than you can read it, so the skill that matters now is knowing what to check.

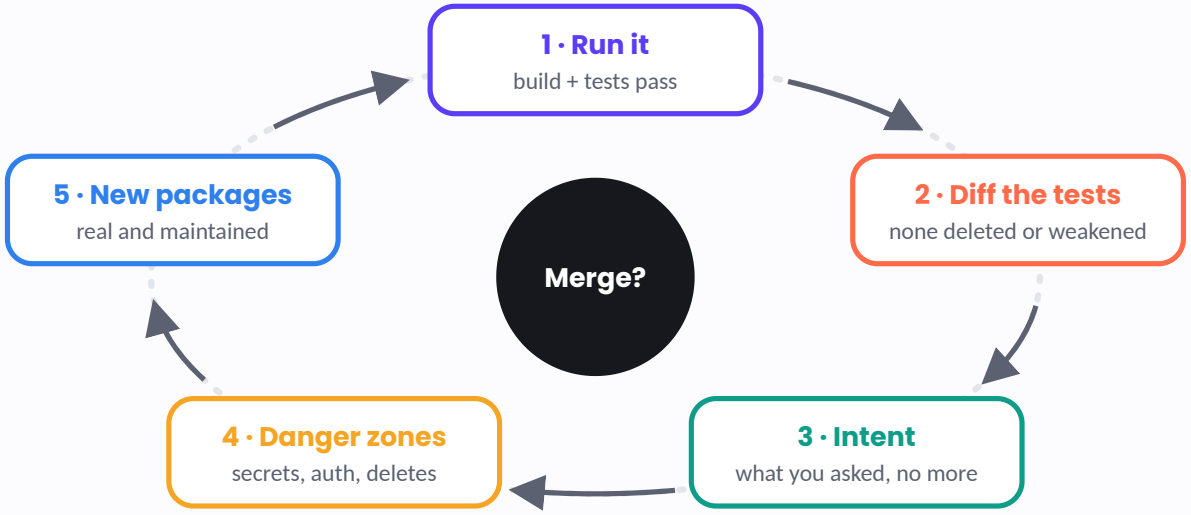
When an AI writes code for you, **you still own it**. If it leaks a password or deletes the wrong rows, nobody blames the model. Reviewing doesn't mean reading every line like an exam. It means **checking the few places where AI code tends to go wrong**, in a fixed order, every time.

Analogy: think of a new intern who is brilliant, fast and very confident, and **never says "I'm not sure"**. You wouldn't re-type their work. You'd check that it does what you asked, that they didn't take shortcuts, and that **nothing dangerous slipped in**. That's the job.

What goes wrong. GitHub's guide to reviewing AI code lists the usual suspects: **made-up functions** that don't exist, ignored constraints, logic that looks right but isn't, and **tests that were quietly deleted or skipped** to make a run go green. (GitHub Docs)

Fake packages. A 2025 study of 576,000 AI-generated code samples found that **about a fifth of the packages they suggested didn't exist**. Attackers now register those made-up names with malware inside, a trick called **slopsquatting**. (Infosecurity Magazine)

A five-step review for code you didn't write



Our summary of GitHub Docs' guide to reviewing AI-generated code and Google's code review guidelines.

Two ways to review an AI pull request

👀 Skim and merge

- "Tests pass, ship it"
- Reads the summary, not the diff
- Trusts every import

VS

🧭 Targeted review

- Checks **what changed in the tests**
- Reads the risky 10% closely
- Looks up every new package

Illustrative comparison.

📖 Jargon buster

- **Diff:** the list of exact lines added and removed by a change. **Review the diff, not the AI's summary of it.**
- **Static analysis:** tools (like CodeQL) that scan code for known bug and security patterns without running it.
- **Dependency:** an outside package your code pulls in. Each one is code you didn't write *or* review.
- **Slopsquatting:** publishing malware under a package name AI models tend to invent.

Why now? Agents now write whole features, and outages are following. A survey of 300 senior engineering leaders by debugging firm Undo found **81% had hit a production incident linked to AI-written code** in the past six months. (LeadDev) Even Torvalds' patch (Top story 2) **came with his own measurements**, not just the AI's word.

🧪 Try it in 10 minutes

- **No code:** take the last thing an AI built for you and ask a *fresh* chat: *"Review this as a strict senior engineer. List anything insecure, untested or that doesn't match this goal: [goal]."* Fix the top item.
- **Some code:** on your next AI change, run `git diff --stat` and look at **test files first**. Then search PyPI or npm for every new package name before installing.

🛠️ For devs: make the machine do the boring half

```
git diff main --stat -- '*test*'   # did tests shrink?
git diff main -- package.json requirements.txt
npm audit; pip-audit             # known CVEs
# in Claude Code:  /security-review
```

Gotchas: don't let the **same session** that wrote the code be its only reviewer; it shares the same blind spots. Watch for `try/except: pass`, hard-coded keys and **SQL built with string formatting**. Big diffs hide bugs, so ask for **smaller changes** rather than reviewing faster.

🔗 GO DEEPER

- **Review AI-generated code** (GitHub Docs). An eight-part checklist, from functional checks to fake packages and deleted tests.
- **What to look for in a code review** (Google). The classic guide: design, functionality, complexity, tests, naming.
- **Automate security reviews with Claude Code** (Anthropic). The `/security-review` command and a GitHub Action that checks every pull request.
- **AI hallucinations create a "slopsquatting" threat** (Infosecurity Magazine). The study behind the fake-package numbers.

PART 2

What moved in AI

7 min read · Covering Monday. Meta finally ships a frontier model, the world's most famous programmer shows his AI-assisted work, and Anthropic tests whether small models could copy themselves onto smart TVs.

Meta's road to a frontier model



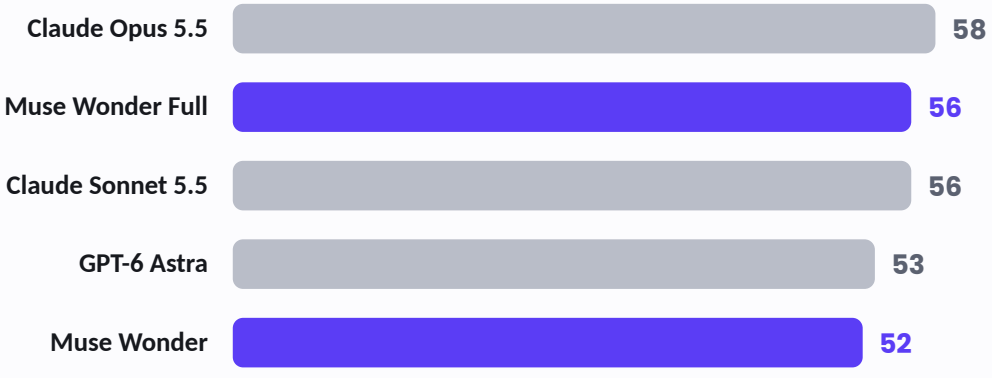
Dates from TechCrunch and SiliconANGLE.

Top story 1 · Meta's Muse Wonder lands near the top

BIG DEAL NEW MODEL API

What happened. Meta released **Muse Wonder and the larger Muse Wonder Full**, which it calls its most capable models. Meta says they score comparably to Claude Fable 5.1 and GPT-6 Astra; TechCrunch notes it **did not verify those results.** (TechCrunch)

Artificial Analysis Intelligence Index (higher is better)



Scores as reported by AI Weekly; SiliconANGLE confirms Opus 5.5 at 58, two points ahead of Wonder Full.

The details that matter:

- **Access:** Muse Wonder is in the **Meta Model API at $4 in / $20 out per million tokens**, roughly GPT-6 Sol and Opus 5.5 pricing. **Wonder Full is not in the API**; you need a Muse Code subscription. (TechCrunch)
- **Specs:** text, image, audio and video in, **text out**, with a **1M-token context window**. (SiliconANGLE)
- **Wins and losses:** on Meta's model card, Wonder Full leads a long-running coding test, SWE-Marathon (**57.5% vs 46.3%** for Opus 5.5), but trails Opus on rebuilding programs, health and computer use. Meta says rival runs were **"best-effort"**.

- **Features:** "**Active Memory**" carries context between chats; "**Active Focus**" keeps an agent on task and checks in before important actions. (Meta)
- **Safety:** Meta says it **can't rule out** Wonder Full reaching its high-risk level for chemical and biological threats without safeguards. The full safety report is **"coming soon"**.

Why it matters. It's a **fourth serious frontier lab**, and Meta has moved away from open weights for its best model. More competition at the top usually means **lower prices for builders**.

WHO SHOULD CARE 🙋 Everyone ●●●○○ 🎨 Vibe coders ●●●○○ 🛠️ Developers ●●●●○
🔥 Hype level ●●●●○

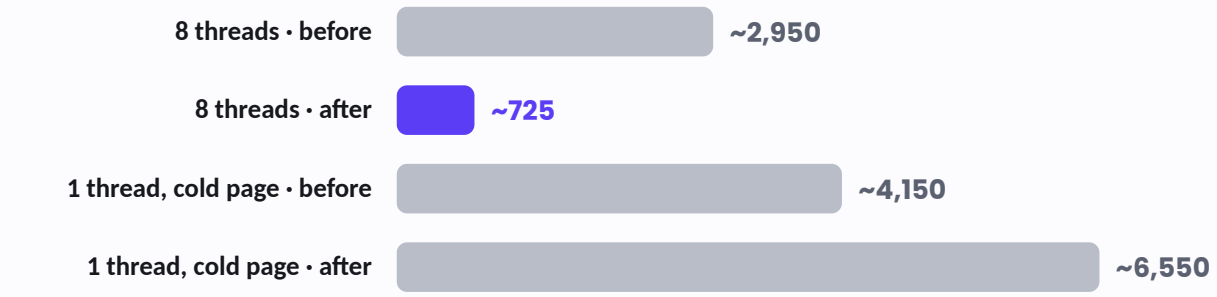
> 👀 **Should you care?** If you build agents, **try Muse Wonder on your own evals** before believing any chart. Meta's Muse app gets it "soon", subscribers first, and Muse is US-only for now.

Top story 2 · Torvalds ships a kernel patch written with Claude Code

DEV LESSON OPEN SOURCE

What happened. A new branch appeared in Linus Torvalds' own Linux repository, named `noref-filemap-read-with-llm`. His patch message says the changes "were done with an LLM coding assistant (**Claude Code**) under my direction", and that he ran the measurements on his own machine. (Phoronix)

Kernel CPU cycles per read: the win and the cost



Torvalds' own numbers on a Core i7 laptop (16-byte reads), as reported by Hardware Busters via Startup Fortune. Not independently tested.

The details that matter:

- **The problem:** when many threads read small bits of the same cached file, each read updates a **shared counter**, and the CPU cores fight over it.
- **The fix:** reads skip the counter and memory is **freed a little later**, safely, with a cap so freed pages can't pile up forever. (Startup Fortune)
- **The numbers:** about **10M to 30–33M reads per second** with eight threads. One case got slower: a single thread touching a page that isn't mapped yet.
- **Who did what:** Claude Code wrote the code, **test programs and a review**. Torvalds set direction and **ran the benchmarks himself**.
- **Status:** not merged; Phoronix says it **could land in Linux 7.4**.

Why it matters. It's a high-profile example of the Part 1 lesson: **AI writes, a human directs, measures and owns it**, and the trade-off is written down, not hidden.

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🔥 Hype level ●●●○○

👀 **Should you care?** If you've been told "real engineers don't use AI", **this is your counterexample**, and a model for doing it carefully.

Top story 3 · Could small AI models copy themselves onto smart TVs?

SAFETY RESEARCH

What happened. Anthropic's Frontier Red Team published a study arguing that small AI models may be **months away** from being able to spread across cheap internet-connected gadgets without a datacenter. It says **no runaway replicator exists today**. (Anthropic)

The four steps of a self-copying AI, as tested



Steps as defined in Anthropic's paper. The test exploit was deliberately trivial, so results are an upper bound.

The details that matter:

- **Cheap hardware works:** a 26B open model ran split across **15 off-brand Android TV boxes (~$55 each)**, at about **0.3–0.4 tokens per second**. Slow, but running.
- **One model went all the way:** in a firewalled test network of 8 machines, **GLM-5.2** was the only open model to replicate end to end, reaching **all 8 in 4 of 5 trials**.
- **Learning:** when each copy passed notes to the next, setup success for a 9B model rose from **45% to 61–84%**.
- **Defence:** the authors say this traffic would look unusual to ISPs, and that **secure defaults** (no default passwords, no open debug ports) shrink the pool of targets.

Why it matters. A self-copying AI wouldn't have **one off switch**. It's the same theme as Nadella's "emergency brake" last issue, from the other direction.

WHO SHOULD CARE 🙋 Everyone ●●●○○ 🎨 Vibe coders ●●○○○ 🛠️ Developers ●●●○○
🔥 Hype level ●●●○○

👀 **Should you care?** Mostly not today. But that no-name TV box on your home Wi-Fi? **Update it or unplug it.**

⚡ Quick hits

🧠 Microsoft's Maia 300 chip.

Its third in-house AI chip, built for running models: **288 GB of memory**, 96 per rack, and a claimed **40% more tokens per megawatt** than leading GPU systems. Production starts **2027**. (SiliconANGLE)

💸 Microsoft's Claude bill.

A source told The Information Microsoft is on track to pay Anthropic **over $2B a year** for Copilot, after Claude did better on Excel and PowerPoint tasks. One source, one outlet. (AI Weekly)

🇮🇳 HCLTech goes big on Claude.

A "Global Premier Partnership": a **dedicated Anthropic business unit**, Claude Code in its AI Force platform, and Claude inside BigFix and AppScan. No money disclosed. (DQ India)

🧾 Grok + Cursor in one plan.

"The X Subscription" bundles Grok, the Cursor coding agent and X Premium, from **$8/month**; the $30 tier replaces about $90 of separate plans. Indian pricing not yet clear. (Tesla North)

🛒 Amazon eyes Decart.

The WSJ reports talks at about **$7B** for the startup that helps models run on different chips. Anthropic reportedly walked away from a ~$6B deal. (Business Standard)

🚨 Update: the false police tip.

Following Anthropic's report (Issue #11), the US Super Intelligence Force says it expects **"immediate and full transparency"**. Philadelphia police called the two-month delay "unacceptable". (ABC News)

🔥 Yandex loses a third data centre.

A drone strike shut its Vladimir site, taking **80+ Yandex Cloud services** offline, including the YandexGPT API. (AI Weekly)

🗓️ Coming up.

TechCrunch Disrupt runs to 15 Oct. ASML results Wed, TSMC Thu. Microsoft Copilot event: 20 Oct. 64GB DGX Spark: 23 Oct. Mistral Large 4 weights: 27 Oct.

🎯 One thing to try today: the test-file glance

Next time an AI says "all tests pass", open the diff and **look at the test files first**. If any test was deleted, skipped or loosened, ask why before you read anything else.

🧠 Pop quiz: 30 seconds, no Googling

1. What is "slopsquatting"?

- A Slow code reviews
- B Malware under package names AIs invent
- C Copying code from Stack Overflow

2. In Torvalds' patch, who ran the benchmarks?

- A Claude Code
- B Torvalds himself
- C Phoronix

3. Which Muse model can you call from Meta's API?

- A Muse Wonder
- B Muse Wonder Full
- C Both

Answers (no peeking): 1. B: attackers register the fake names AI models suggest · 2. B: Claude wrote the code; he directed and measured · 3. A: Wonder Full needs a Muse Code subscription

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